Primary Care Clinic | PSR Quick Reference

HIPAA Communication Forms: Reported Issues and Corrective Actions

Recent reviews found HIPAA communication forms and contact information that were incomplete, outdated, or not updated at registration. Use this sheet to catch and correct each issue at the desk, every encounter.

Issues Reported and Corrective Actions

Issue Reported	Corrective Action at Registration
HIPAA form not completed	Complete the form with the patient before check-in is finished.
Form only partly completed	Review every required section. Ask the patient about each blank before moving on.
Missing patient phone number	Read back the number on file and confirm it. Add a working number if none is listed.
Alternate contacts not documented	Ask whether there is anyone else we may contact. Document their name and phone number.
Emergency and authorized contacts entered incorrectly	Ask which role each person has. Enter emergency contacts and authorized contacts in their correct places.
Marked "declined" with earlier documentation on file	Ask the patient about the earlier form. Document their current wishes; never assume "declined."
Outdated form active for years	Review the form with the patient today and update it to their current wishes.
Contact information not reviewed at check-in	Confirm phone, address, and email (when applicable) at every encounter, new or returning.
Insurance not reviewed or updated	Verify insurance and scan current cards at every encounter.
Inaccurate names or incomplete demographics on the form	Spell out full names (first and last) and relationship. Confirm spelling with the patient.

Every Encounter Checklist

1. Identify the patient with two identifiers: name and date of birth.
2. Confirm phone numbers, address, and email when applicable.
3. Verify insurance and scan current cards.
4. Review the HIPAA form: all sections complete, contact names accurate, a phone number for every contact.
5. Clarify any blank or incomplete section with the patient before they leave.

Do Not Assume

- ✕ Information from previous years is still correct.
- ✕ A patient wants a contact removed, unless they specifically ask.
- ✕ A blank section can wait until next visit.

Not sure how to complete the form? Ask the Clinic Manager before the patient leaves. It is much harder to fix later.

If we cannot reach the patient, we cannot coordinate their care.